life. Main roads known as Peruvali were built for surface transportation. Besides state expanded infrastructure for shipping such as ports, lighthouse, warehouse etc.. to promote overseas trade. Many such ports were developed during the Sangam period. Kaveripumpattinam was the chief port of the Kingdom of Cholas while Nagapattinam, Marakannam, Arikamedu etc. were other small ports on east coast. Similarly Pandiyas developed Korkai, Saliyur, Kayal, Marungaur pattinam and Kumari for foreign trade. The State Govertments installed check posts to collect customs along the highways and the ports.

Contribution of 'Kautilya' to Trade

''Kautilya's Arthasastra" describes economy in Mauriyan time. This brought out history of marketing practised some 2000 years ago. According to Kautilya, trade in Medieval India was centralized. Since the commodities produced could not be sold in the location of production, the state designated certain places for selling the commodities. It levied duties on goods brought into the city and could be sold after payment of duty. Only certain merchants were authorized to engage in trade to sell at prices fixed by the chief controllers of State Trading. The profit margin allowed for traders ranged between 5 per cent for indigenous goods and 10 per cent for imported goods. Import of foreign goods was encouraged to enhance the standard of living of people. Kautilya gave importance for the State in relation to treasury, taxation, industry, commerce, agriculture and conservation of natural resources. Arthasathra focused on creation of wealth as the means to

Important Ancient Trade Centres In The Coastal Regions Of Tamil Nadu

1. Alambarai
2. Alagankulam
3. Pumpuhar
4. Marakkanam
5. Vasavasamudram
6. Mylapore


RIVER VAIGAI

ALAGANKULAM

Location: A village situated on the east coast of Bay of Bengal – Ramanathapuram district. Attankarai – confluence of river Vaigai situated near Sri Lanka

Significance: Findings - large number of potsherds of mediterranean origin

Roman coins of Valentine II, Arcadius & Theodosius II Pot sherds with Roman ship graffiti. Sherds with two lady figurines identified with Egyptian origin. Tamil brahmi sherds with Ceylon brahmi scripts are found in an ancient Roman port. The department carried out excavations in eight seasons and the collected artefacts revealed Indo-Roman trade contact.

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